

Gradient Formulas

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1 Gradient Formulas

The likelihood for a point x_i is

$$p(x_i | \pi, \mu, \sigma^2) = \pi_1 \mathcal{N}(x_i | \mu_1, \sigma_1^2) + \pi_2 \mathcal{N}(x_i | \mu_2, \sigma_2^2).$$

The log-likelihood for m data points is

$$\mathcal{L} = \sum_{i=1}^m \log \left(\sum_{k=1}^2 \pi_k \mathcal{N}(x_i | \mu_k, \sigma_k^2) \right).$$

Define the responsibility of component k for data point i :

$$\gamma_{ik} = \frac{\pi_k \mathcal{N}(x_i | \mu_k, \sigma_k^2)}{\sum_{j=1}^2 \pi_j \mathcal{N}(x_i | \mu_j, \sigma_j^2)}.$$

We also know:

$$\mathcal{N}(x | \mu, \sigma^2) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi\sigma^2}} \exp\left(-\frac{(x - \mu)^2}{2\sigma^2}\right).$$

1.1 Mean Gradient

$$\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \mu_k} = \sum_{i=1}^m \frac{1}{\sum_{j=1}^2 \pi_j \mathcal{N}(x_i | \mu_j, \sigma_j^2)} \cdot \frac{\pi_k}{\sqrt{2\pi\sigma_k^2}} \exp\left(-\frac{(x_i - \mu_k)^2}{2\sigma_k^2}\right) \cdot \frac{x_i - \mu_k}{\sigma_k^2} \quad (1)$$

$$= \sum_{i=1}^m \frac{\pi_k \mathcal{N}(x_i | \mu_k, \sigma_k^2)}{\sum_{j=1}^2 \pi_j \mathcal{N}(x_i | \mu_j, \sigma_j^2)} \cdot \frac{x_i - \mu_k}{\sigma_k^2} \quad (2)$$

$$= \sum_{i=1}^m \gamma_{ik} \cdot \frac{x_i - \mu_k}{\sigma_k^2}. \quad (3)$$

1.2 Variance Gradient

$$\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \sigma_k^2} = \sum_{i=1}^m \frac{1}{\sum_{j=1}^2 \pi_j \mathcal{N}(x_i | \mu_j, \sigma_j^2)} \cdot \pi_k \cdot \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi\sigma_k^2}} \exp\left(-\frac{(x_i - \mu_k)^2}{2\sigma_k^2}\right) \cdot \left(-\frac{1}{2\sigma_k^2} + \frac{(x_i - \mu_k)^2}{2\sigma_k^4}\right) \quad (4)$$

$$\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \sigma_k^2} = \sum_{i=1}^m \frac{1}{\sum_{j=1}^2 \pi_j \mathcal{N}(x_i | \mu_j, \sigma_j^2)} \cdot \pi_k \cdot \mathcal{N}(x_i | \mu_k, \sigma_k^2) \cdot \left(-\frac{1}{2\sigma_k^2} + \frac{(x_i - \mu_k)^2}{2\sigma_k^4}\right) \quad (5)$$

$$= \frac{1}{2} \sum_{i=1}^m \gamma_{ik} \left(\frac{(x_i - \mu_k)^2}{\sigma_k^4} - \frac{1}{\sigma_k^2} \right) \quad (6)$$

1.3 Mixture weights gradient (with constraint)

$$\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \pi_k} = \sum_{i=1}^m \frac{1}{\sum_{j=1}^2 \pi_j \mathcal{N}(x_i | \mu_j, \sigma_j^2)} \cdot \mathcal{N}(x_i | \mu_k, \sigma_k^2) \quad (7)$$

$$= \sum_{i=1}^m \frac{\pi_k \mathcal{N}(x_i | \mu_k, \sigma_k^2)}{\sum_{j=1}^2 \pi_j \mathcal{N}(x_i | \mu_j, \sigma_j^2)} \cdot \frac{1}{\pi_k} \quad (8)$$

$$= \sum_{i=1}^m \frac{\gamma_{ik}}{\pi_k} \quad (9)$$